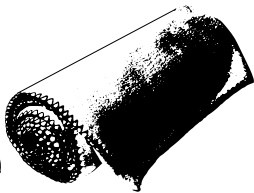


SALVAGING TEXTILES FROM THE TRASH



So you found a pile of clothing and/or linens on the side of the road and some of it looks useable. Waste not, want not.

You can clean up your neighborhood, bring those items back into use, and share community abundance.

What you'll need:

- Washing machine & dryer
- Laundry detergent
- Big tub of OxiClean (it's color safe!)
- Gloves
- Grabber/reacher tool
- Plastic bags

Nice to have:

- Bag for recyclables
- Bag for unusable trash and a place to dispose of it
- Sharps container

This act of salvage and reuse is a kind of "waste picking."

Waste picking is about pulling from the waste what one sees value in (whether for reuse or recycling).



Pick up things with your grabber to avoid touching biohazards, like rotting food and used needles. Make sure your plastic bags are water tight so any water in the textiles doesn't leak.



Before you get started, make sure it's ok to take those items.

While it's great to harvest abandoned materials, make sure they are truly abandoned. Do not take things next to an active campsite. You could be stealing from someone's home.

If you encounter a camper, introduce yourself and tell them what you are doing. Usually they will think it's cool, but if they ask you to leave, leave.

If you find a cache of stuff that looks organized or has a sleeping bag with it, someone may be coming back for it. Observe for a few days before removing the items.

CLEANING YOUR HAUL

- Empty pockets and remove large detritus like leaves and twigs
- Add detergent and a scoop of OxiClean
- Wash on the hottest/heaviest setting you have
- Do not overload your washing machine or dryer or it will be harder to get rid of stains and odors
- Don't attempt to work on items that are VERY stinky—there's nothing your regular washing machine can do about it, not even bleach will save them

- Once dry, sort out damaged items

WARNINGS ABOUT WOOL

Wool is an amazing material for clothing but it needs some special care. Washing in hot water will shrink and felt wool, so stick to cold water. Wool items must be washed immediately upon collection to prevent the spread of wool moths.

Finally, do not bother with the fragile wool blankets that are given to houseless folks. They are intended to degrade naturally and will destroy your washer and dryer.

MENDING

If you're up for the challenge, sew on patches, cover stains, and replace zippers.

Mending Bloc has zines to help you learn how!

mendingbloc.carrd.co:



PLACES TO SHARE YOUR HAUL

- *Buy Nothing* groups
- Free stores
- School clothing closets
- Houseless outreach orgs
- Waste picker orgs
- Shelters
- Churches